LobbyView Version History

If you have used LobbyView data in the past, you may benefit from reading the below version history release notes to understand how the data has changed. Changes which BREAK compatibility with old versions of the data are noted in bold.

v2024.10.01

- **BREAKING CHANGES**: Previous versions of LobbyView data are not compatible with data beginning with this version. Please see below for details:
  - The method through which we identify bills lobbied by particular filings has changed. This will result in more identified bills. We cannot guarantee that bills previously associated with a given filing are still associated with the same filing.
  - Clients are now identified by the identifier `lob_id`, which is not backwards compatible with previous identifiers (including `client_uuid`). This change was made because we changed the way we identify unique client entities to improve disambiguation. This affects the report, network, and client datasets. Attempting to merge current LobbyView data with previous LobbyView data will fail. We are investigating making available a crosswalk for these identifiers, but do not have an ETA to share for this. We expect the `lob_id` identifiers will stay consistent over time, and any future database crosswalks we release will use these to connect to records in external databases.
- All data updated through 2024Q3.
- New dataset: Lobbyists. We have recently concluded an effort to disambiguate individual lobbyists and provide metadata about their careers. We expect to augment this data with individual-level education, occupation, and demographic data in the future.
- New codebooks: We have replaced our codebooks with new and more detailed codebooks which describe each field in more detail and include extra documentation for associated metadata.
- Added version history (this document)
- Version numbers: Going forward, version numbers of LobbyView data will be identified by a three part version number: vYYYY.MM.VV, where YYYY refers to the year of release (2024), MM refers to the month of release (10), and VV refers to the number of the release within the month. We are still evaluating the release cadence, but expect that within-month changes will only be used to correct emergency errors.